Mom's Financial Paperwork in One Place

A one-page inventory of the accounts, policies and statements you already have, who holds each one, and the ones still missing.

The bank statements are in Mom's desk, the insurance policy is at your brother's, and the pension letter might be in the glove box.

This page doesn't ask you to understand any of it, or to add any of it up. It asks where each thing is, how recent it is, and who has it.

WHAT TO COLLECT	WHERE IT IS	ITS DATE	WHO HAS IT
Social Security benefit letter or statement			
Pension paperwork			
Checking, savings, CD and money market account statements			
Investment and brokerage account statements			
Retirement account statements			
Life insurance policies, and anything showing a cash value			
Annuity contracts and statements			
Long-term care insurance policy			
Deeds and other records for any real estate			
Titles and registrations for vehicles and other significant property			
Mortgage, loan and credit card statements			
Recent tax returns			
Bills or the rate sheet from the facility or care provider			

What's missing, and who will look for it

Anything above with an empty line. Put a name next to each.

FOR EXAMPLE No statement for the credit union account. Karen will ask at the branch on Monday.

How to use it

- Write the date printed on each item, so you can see which ones are recent.
- Don't copy balances or account numbers onto this page. It's a map of where the papers are, not a ledger.
- Where a paper shows a name other than Mom's, or more than one name, write the names beside the row as they are printed.
- If a statement only arrives online, write “online” under where it is, and note who is able to print one.
- Bring this page, with the papers, to any conversation about paying for Mom's care.

What this page doesn't do

It doesn't explain what any statement, policy or deed means, and it doesn't say which records matter for Mom's situation. Rules vary by state, so that is a question for your Medicaid planner. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You know where each paper is, who has it, and which ones are still missing. The planning interview uses what you've collected: it asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report to bring, along with the papers, to any conversation about paying for care.

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WHERE THIS COMES FROM

Many of the rows follow the lists of financial papers that the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau suggests keeping together and that the Family Caregiver Alliance's “Where to Find My Important Papers” form has a line for. The rest come from the Medicaid Planning Roadmap's working list for this step.

1. Consumer Financial Protection Bureau, Planning for diminished capacity and illness
2. Family Caregiver Alliance, Where to Find My Important Papers